

## Topics:

1. Polishing style: paragraphs
2. Sentence structure, clarity, length and order
3. Pomposity, empty words, pompous vocabulary
4. Document design
5. Document structure, preamble, summaries, and abstracts
6. Table of contents
7. Footnotes, glossaries, and cross-referencing

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### Polishing style: paragraphs

Polishing a paragraph means improving its flow, clarity, and connection between ideas so the message is well-structured and easy to understand.

#### Features:

- ✓ **Unity:** One paragraph = one main idea.
- ✓ **Coherence:** Sentences are logically connected.
- ✓ **Order:** Logical order (chronological, importance, etc.)

#### Advantages:

- ✓ Improves readability
- ✓ Helps readers understand your point clearly
- ✓ Makes writing look professional and organized

#### Example:

**Weak:** “The product was launched. Many customers liked it. It sold well.”

**Polished:** “The product launch received positive feedback from customers, leading to strong sales.”



## Sentence structure, clarity, length and order

Good sentence structure ensures each sentence is grammatically correct, clear, not too long, and in the correct word order (Subject → Verb → Object).

### Types:

- ✓ **Simple:** One idea (e.g., “She passed the test.”)
- ✓ **Compound:** Two ideas joined (e.g., “She passed, and she celebrated.”)
- ✓ **Complex:** Main + dependent clause (e.g., “She passed because she studied.”)

### Advantages:

- ✓ Increases clarity
- ✓ Avoids confusion or misinterpretation
- ✓ Makes content smooth and engaging

### Example:

**Bad:** “There was a delay in the process caused by miscommunication.”

**Good:** “Miscommunication caused a delay in the process.”

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## Pomposity, empty words, pompous vocabulary

### • Pomposity:

Pomposity is writing in an overly formal or showy way to sound important, which often makes the message confusing or annoying.

### Advantages of avoiding pomposity:

- ✓ Makes writing natural and relatable
- ✓ Builds trust with the reader
- ✓ Increases understanding

## **Example:**

**Pompous:** “The individual in question partook in nocturnal slumber.”

**Simple:** “He slept at night.”

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- **Empty Words:**

Empty words are phrases that don’t add value or meaning to your writing; they just take up space.

## **Common Empty Words:**

- ✓ "It is important to note that..."
- ✓ "Due to the fact that..."
- ✓ "In order to..."

## **Advantages of avoiding empty words:**

- ✓ Makes writing shorter and sharper
- ✓ Keeps the reader focused on key points
- ✓ Improves the impact of your message

## **Example:**

**Before:** “In order to complete the project, we must work harder.”

**After:** “To complete the project, we must work harder.”

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- **Pompous Vocabulary:**

Pompous vocabulary refers to using difficult, fancy, or outdated words when simpler ones would work better.

## Advantages of avoiding pompous vocabulary:

- ✓ Makes writing easier to read
- ✓ Improves accessibility for all readers
- ✓ Saves time and space

## Example:

| Pompous Word | Simpler Word |
|--------------|--------------|
| Commence     | Start        |
| Utilize      | Use          |
| Ascertain    | Find out     |

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## Document design

Document design is about how the content appears visually — including layout, headings, fonts, spacing, images, and color.

## Elements:

- ✓ Headings and subheadings
- ✓ Bullet points
- ✓ White space
- ✓ Charts, tables, and images

## Advantages:

- ✓ Attracts and retains attention
- ✓ Improves navigation
- ✓ Highlights important info

## Example:

A clean, spaced report with clear headings and images is easier to read than a wall of text.

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## Document structure, preamble, summaries, and abstracts

- **Document Structure:**

Document structure refers to the logical arrangement of different parts of a document so the content flows clearly from beginning to end.

### **Common Structure:**

1. **Title Page**
2. **Table of Contents**
3. **Introduction**
4. **Body (Main Content)**
5. **Conclusion**
6. **References / Appendices**

### **Advantages:**

- ✓ Helps readers follow the content easily
- ✓ Improves the professional appearance
- ✓ Makes writing organized and understandable

### **Example:**

A project report starts with an introduction, followed by objectives, methodology, results, and then a conclusion.

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- **Preamble:**

A preamble is a short introductory paragraph or statement placed before the main content of a document. It sets the tone and context for what follows.

### **Advantages:**

- ✓ Provides background or purpose
- ✓ Prepares the reader for the main content

- ✓ Builds interest or attention

### **Example:**

**“This report presents the annual performance of the sales department, outlining key achievements and challenges.”**

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- **Summaries:**

A summary is a brief restatement of the main points or findings, usually placed at the end of a section, chapter, or document.

### **Advantages:**

- ✓ Helps readers recall key points
- ✓ Saves time for those skimming
- ✓ Reinforces important information

### **Example:**

#### **Summary of a chapter:**

“In this chapter, we explored the reasons for declining sales and identified customer dissatisfaction and delivery delays as key issues.”

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- **Abstract:**

An abstract is a concise overview of an entire document, typically 100–250 words. It is placed at the beginning of reports, theses, or research papers.

### **Advantages:**

- ✓ Gives a quick understanding of the whole content
- ✓ Useful for researchers or decision-makers
- ✓ Helps readers decide if the full document is relevant

### Example:

**“This study examines the impact of online learning on student performance. A survey of 200 students was conducted, and results showed a 20% increase in self-paced learning effectiveness...”**

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## Table of contents

A list of chapters, sections, or headings with page numbers that helps the reader navigate a document.

### Advantages:

- ✓ Easy navigation
- ✓ Quick access to specific topics
- ✓ Gives an overview of the document layout

### Example:

|                       |   |
|-----------------------|---|
| 1. Introduction ..... | 1 |
| 2. Objectives .....   | 2 |
| 3. Findings .....     | 5 |

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## Footnotes, glossaries, and cross-referencing

### • Footnotes:

Footnotes are small notes or references placed at the **bottom of a page** in a document to give extra information, cite sources, or explain a point without interrupting the main text.

## Advantages:

- ✓ Adds supporting details or citations without cluttering the main content
- ✓ Maintains the flow of reading
- ✓ Shows credibility and references clearly

## Example:

In the main text:

"The data was collected from official records.<sup>1</sup>"

At the bottom of the page:

<sup>1</sup> Source: GIGCCL Annual Report 2024

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- **Glossaries:**

A glossary is a **list of difficult or technical terms** used in the document, along with their **definitions**, usually placed at the end of the document.

## Advantages:

- ✓ Helps readers understand unfamiliar or technical terms
- ✓ Makes documents user-friendly for all readers
- ✓ Saves space by not needing to explain terms repeatedly

## Example:

In a glossary section at the end:

- **Bandwidth:** The amount of data that can be transferred over a network in a specific time.
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- **Cross References:**



Cross-referencing is a method of pointing the reader to **another part** of the document for more information related to the current topic.

### Advantages:

- ✓ Helps the reader locate related content quickly
- ✓ Improves navigation in long documents
- ✓ Avoids repetition by linking to existing sections

### Example:

“For details about the annual budget, see **Section 4.2** on page 15.”

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### Quick One-Liners for Revision:

| Topic                              | One-Liner                                                       |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Polishing Paragraphs               | Makes writing clear and well-organized around one idea.         |
| Sentence Structure                 | Ensures clarity with correct word order and short sentences.    |
| Pomposity                          | Avoids showy or overly formal language to stay reader-friendly. |
| Empty Words                        | Removing them improves directness and reduces clutter.          |
| Pompous Vocabulary                 | Use simple words for better understanding and impact.           |
| Document Design                    | Makes the document look neat and easier to read.                |
| Document Structure                 | Organizes content using intro, summary, and abstract.           |
| Table of Contents                  | Guides readers to the desired section quickly.                  |
| Footnotes/Glossary/Cross-Reference | Adds clarity, references, and support without breaking flow.    |

